RANGERS' EARTHRANGER DATA REVIEW AND SEPTEMBER FEEDBACK REPORT

NAIBUNGA LOWER CONSERVANCY

Introduction

The Rangers' EarthRanger Data Review and Feedback Meeting, held on 17 October 2026 at the HQ, aimed to review patrol activities and data recorded during September 2026 at Naibunga Lower Conservancy. The meeting focused on assessing patrol-block coverage, reviewing data quality and reporting, and identifying challenges experienced by rangers in the field, particularly their adaptation to the new EarthRanger data models. It also provided an opportunity to discuss areas requiring additional guidance and support to improve data collection, strengthen reporting, and support effective conservation management. The findings will inform operational improvements and provide the conservancy's donor with a clear overview of progress, challenges, and support needs.

Main Agenda

1. Review of ranger data collection and reporting through EarthRanger
2. Review of data recorded during September 2026
3. Assessment of data completeness and quality
4. Review of patrol-block coverage and patrol-effort mapping
5. Discussion of challenges experienced by rangers while using the new data models
6. Identification of improvements and follow-up actions

Ranger Data Collection and Reporting

The review identified limited familiarity with the new EarthRanger data models as a key challenge. This one has resulted incomplete records, with some required data fields left unfilled during field data collection and reporting. Continued guidance and support are needed to help rangers adapt to the new models and ensure all required information is captured accurately.

Data Collected During the Month

A total of 62 records were recorded during September 2026, covering wildlife observations, patrol activities, and other conservation-related incidents.

- **Wildlife sightings:** 47 records.
- **Indirect wildlife observations (spoor):** 27 records.
- **Direct wildlife observations (visual):** 14 records.
- **Patrol information:** 11 records.
- **Illegal activity:** 1 record.
- **Human–wildlife conflict (livestock predation):** 1 record.
- **Infrastructure damage:** 1 record.
- **Injured/abandoned animal:** 1 record.

Improvement Action: Conduct monthly data checks to identify missing information and ensure accurate, complete records for conservation reporting.

Patrol Block Coverage

The September 2026 patrol review highlighted variations in patrol coverage across Naibunga Lower Conservancy. Some blocks received limited or no patrol attention due to their distance from patrol bases and the unavailability of transport to access these areas. The Plans we're put in order to improve accessibility and ensure more consistent patrol coverage across the conservancy.

Way Forward

- Develop patrol schedules that consider all blocks, giving attention to distant and less-accessible areas.
- Communicate transport requirements to management in advance to facilitate patrols where vehicle support is needed.

- Regularly review patrol records and the patrol-effort map to identify coverage gaps and guide future patrol planning.

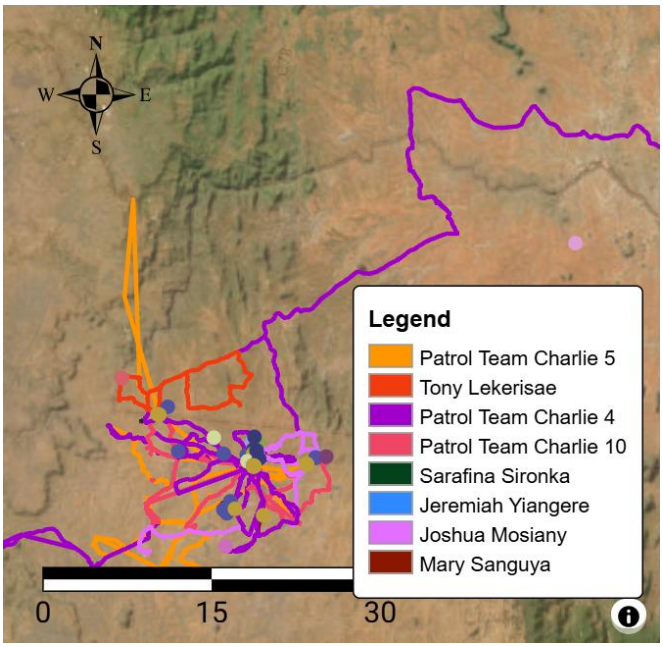


Figure 1.1 Patrol-effort map for September.

Challenges Identified

The challenge identified was the limited familiarity of rangers with the new data models. This has made it difficult for some rangers to complete all required data fields during field reporting, potentially resulting in incomplete records

Interactive Review and Ranger Feedback

The session provided an opportunity for rangers to share field experiences, review patrol coverage, and discuss challenges affecting patrol operations. The discussion encouraged collaboration among team members and highlighted the importance of effective patrol planning, timely communication, and proper coordination to improve coverage and strengthen conservation monitoring across Naibunga Lower Conservancy.

Recommendations

Based on the findings of the September 2026 EarthRanger data review, the following recommendations are proposed to improve patrol coverage, data quality, and conservation reporting at Naibunga Lower Conservancy.

1. **Improve Patrol Scheduling**
   Responsible: Warden and Assistant Warden
   Develop a patrol schedule covering all blocks, with particular attention to distant areas receiving limited or no patrol coverage.
2. **Coordinate Transport for Distant Patrol Blocks**
   Responsible: Warden and Manager
   Communicate transport requirements in advance and coordinate vehicle availability to facilitate patrols in remote areas.
3. **Provide Support on the New Data Models**
   Responsible: Data Operator
   Provide guidance and clarification to help rangers understand and correctly use the new EarthRanger data models, ensuring all required information is captured.
4. **Improve EarthRanger Data Completeness**
   Responsible: Data Operator and Rangers
   Ensure all required fields are completed during data entry and conduct regular checks to identify missing information and improve reporting quality.
5. **Monitor Patrol Coverage**
   Responsible: Warden, Assistant Warden, and Data Operator
   Review patrol-effort maps and EarthRanger records regularly to identify coverage gaps and guide future patrol planning.
6. **Strengthen Communication and Follow-Up**
   Responsible: Rangers, Warden, Assistant Warden, and Manager
   Ensure field challenges are communicated promptly and that operational needs are addressed to improve patrol effectiveness and reporting.

These recommendations aim to strengthen data quality, support rangers in adapting to the new data models, and promote more balanced patrol coverage across Naibunga Lower Conservancy.

Conclusion

The September 2026 EarthRanger data review highlighted the importance of accurate data entry and effective patrol planning at Naibunga Lower Conservancy. The main challenges identified were the limited familiarity of rangers with the new data models and difficulties accessing distant patrol blocks, which may affect data completeness and patrol coverage.

Addressing these challenges will require coordinated action from management, the supervisory team, rangers, and the Data Operator. Management support in facilitating transport, strengthening ranger capacity, and ensuring regular review of patrol activities will be essential to achieving the desired improvements.

Moving forward, management should ensure that the agreed recommendations are implemented, responsibilities are clearly assigned, and progress is assessed during subsequent review meetings. This will strengthen accountability, improve the quality of conservation data, promote balanced patrol coverage, and ensure that reporting to the donor reflects verified progress, operational challenges, and the effectiveness of actions taken.

Photo



Figure 1. Showing rangers contributing during the meeting.

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